

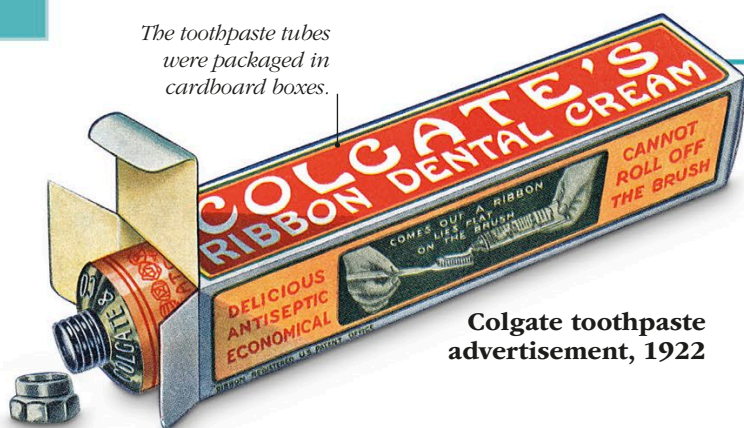
Keeping up appearances

Not all inventions make big, revolutionary changes to the way we live. Some just offer us a bit of much-needed assistance as we go about our daily lives. From helping us to get bright white teeth and keeping our skin healthy to styling hair and painting our nails, here are some beauty-themed inventions that help us look and feel our best.

WOW!

Modern nail polishes were based on a type of car paint.

The toothpaste tubes were packaged in cardboard boxes.



Colgate toothpaste advertisement, 1922

Sparkling teeth

- **What?** Toothpaste in a tube
- **Who?** Washington Sheffield
- **Where and when?** US, 1892

The practice of brushing teeth with a special cleaning paste became widespread in the 19th century, with the paste initially distributed in jars. In the 1890s, the British toothpaste manufacturer Colgate popularized an invention by the American dentist Washington Sheffield—toothpaste in a collapsible metal tube. Sheffield was said to have been inspired by paint that came in tubes. Colgate advertised it with the slogan: “Comes out a ribbon, lies flat on the brush.”

Wet shaving

- **What?** Safety razor
- **Who?** King C. Gillette
- **Where and when?** US, 1901

In the 19th century, men shaved using dangerous “cut-throat” razors with open blades. An American salesperson and inventor, King C. Gillette, came up with the cheaper, safer alternative: disposable blades. Customers would buy a handle into which cheaply made individual blades could be placed. When the blade got dull, it would be thrown away and replaced.



Gillette razor, 1930s

Painted nails

- **What?** Liquid nail polish
- **Who?** Cutex
- **Where and when?** US, 1917

The ancient Chinese were coloring nails as early as 3000 BCE. In the beginning of the 20th century, nail polish usually took the form of a paste or powder, before the American company Cutex introduced the first liquid nail polish in 1917.



Nail polish advertisement, 1937